

the 1990s, the number of people in the UK who are aged 65 and over has increased by 1.5 million (1990–2000) and is projected to increase by a further 1.5 million by 2020 (Office for National Statistics 2001).

There is a growing awareness of the need to address the health care needs of the ageing population. The Department of Health (2000) has set out a vision for the future of health care for older people, and the National Institute for Clinical Excellence (NICE) (2001) has produced guidance on the management of common conditions in older people. The Department of Health (2000) also states that the health care system should be able to meet the needs of older people in a way that is cost-effective, efficient and of high quality.

One of the key challenges facing the health care system is how to ensure that older people receive the care and support they need in a way that is appropriate to their needs and preferences. This paper discusses the challenges facing the health care system in meeting the needs of older people, and explores some of the ways in which the system can be improved to better meet these needs.

The paper is organized as follows. First, we discuss the challenges facing the health care system in meeting the needs of older people. Second, we explore some of the ways in which the system can be improved to better meet these needs. Third, we discuss the implications of these findings for policy and practice. Finally, we conclude with some thoughts on the future of health care for older people.

The challenges facing the health care system in meeting the needs of older people are many and varied. One of the key challenges is how to ensure that older people receive the care and support they need in a way that is appropriate to their needs and preferences. This is a challenge because older people often have complex health needs, and their needs can change over time. In addition, older people may have different preferences for where they receive care and support, and how they receive it.

Another key challenge is how to ensure that the health care system is able to meet the needs of older people in a way that is cost-effective, efficient and of high quality. This is a challenge because the health care system is often underfunded, and there is a growing pressure to reduce costs. In addition, the health care system is often fragmented, and there is a lack of coordination between different parts of the system.

One of the ways in which the health care system can be improved to better meet the needs of older people is by ensuring that older people are able to live in their own homes for as long as possible. This is because living in one's own home is often the best place for older people to live, and it can help to maintain their independence and quality of life. However, many older people are unable to live in their own homes because of health or social reasons.

One of the ways in which the health care system can help older people to live in their own homes is by providing them with the care and support they need. This can be done in a number of ways, including providing home care services, providing respite care services, and providing support groups. In addition, the health care system can help older people to live in their own homes by providing them with information and advice on how to manage their health and care.

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